MARVEL

CIVIL WAR®

CAPTAIN AMERICA

PRELUDE



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LIMITED SERIES
4 OF 4

MARVEL

CIVIL WAR

CAPTAIN AMERICA

PRELUDE part four

CAPTAIN AMERICA, AKA STEVE ROGERS, HAS BEEN WORKING FOR S.H.I.E.L.D. UNDER DIRECTOR **NICK FURY.** FURY BRIEFED ROGERS ON **PROJECT INSIGHT:** A SPY PROGRAM WITH A WIDE SCOPE DESIGNED TO ELIMINATE THREATS.

WHEN FURY WAS LOCKED OUT FROM THE PROJECT DATA, HE BECAME SUSPICIOUS AND REQUESTED THAT SENIOR S.H.I.E.L.D. OFFICIAL **ALEXANDER PIERCE** DELAY IT.

LATER, FURY'S CAR WAS AMBUSHED BY A MYSTERIOUS ASSASSIN CALLED THE **WINTER SOLDIER.** FURY ESCAPED TO CAP'S APARTMENT, AND WARNED HIM THAT S.H.I.E.L.D. WAS COMPROMISED.

WHILE AT THE APARTMENT, FURY WAS SHOT AND KILLED. BUT BEFORE HE DIED, HE HANDED ROGERS A FLASH DRIVE. WHEN CAP REFUSED TO HAND THE INFORMATION OVER TO PIERCE, HE WAS DECLARED A TRAITOR.

USING DATA IN THE FLASH DRIVE, CAP AND **BLACK WIDOW** DISCOVER A SECRET S.H.I.E.L.D. BUNKER, WHERE THEY ACTIVATE A SUPERCOMPUTER CONTAINING NONE OTHER THAN THE CONSCIOUSNESS OF **ARNIM ZOLA!**

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CAMP LEHIGH,
FORMER S.H.I.E.L.D. BASE.

ARNIM ZOLA.
SCIENTIST WHO WORKED FOR THE RED SKULL.

IN 1972, I RECEIVED A TERMINAL DIAGNOSIS. SCIENCE COULD NOT SAVE MY BODY. MY *MIND*, HOWEVER, WAS WORTH SAVING ON 200,000 FEET OF DATABANKS.

YOU ARE STANDING IN MY *BRAIN.*

ACCESSING ARCHIVE.

HYDRA WAS FOUNDED ON THE BELIEF THAT HUMANITY COULD NOT BE TRUSTED WITH ITS OWN FREEDOM. WHAT WE DID NOT REALIZE WAS THAT IF YOU TRY TO *TAKE* THAT FREEDOM, PEOPLE *RESIST.*

THE WAR TAUGHT US MUCH. HUMANITY NEEDED TO SURRENDER ITS FREEDOM *WILLINGLY.*

GERMAN S

AFTER THE WAR, S.H.I.E.L.D. WAS FOUNDED AND *I* WAS *RECRUITED.*

THE NEW HYDRA GREW. A BEAUTIFUL PARASITE *INSIDE* S.H.I.E.L.D.

FOR 70 YEARS HYDRA HAS BEEN SECRETLY FEEDING CRISIS, REAPING WAR...AND WHEN HISTORY DID NOT *COOPERATE*, HISTORY WAS *CHANGED.*

WARD STARK KIL

WHAT'S ON THIS DRIVE?

PROJECT INSIGHT *REQUIRES* INSIGHT. SO, I WROTE AN ALGORITHM.

WHAT KIND OF ALGORITHM? WHAT DOES IT *DO?*

THE ANSWER TO YOUR QUESTION IS FASCINATING, MS. ROMANOFF. UNFORTUNATELY, YOU SHALL BE TOO DEAD TO HEAR IT.

STEVE, WE GOT A BOGEY. SHORT-RANGE BALLISTIC. 30 SECONDS *TOPS.*

ADMIT IT. IT'S BETTER THIS WAY, CAPTAIN. WE ARE, BOTH OF US...

OUT OF TIME.

BOOM

MEANWHILE...

THE TIMETABLE HAS MOVED.

OUR WINDOW IS LIMITED. TWO TARGETS, LEVEL SIX. THEY ALREADY COST ME ZOLA.

I WANT CONFIRMED DEATH IN 10 HOURS.

SORRY, MR. PIERCE, I...I FORGOT MY...PHONE.

OH, RENATA...

I WISH YOU WOULD HAVE KNOCKED.

BLAM

SAM WILSON'S DUPLEX.

HEY, MAN.

I'M SORRY ABOUT THIS. WE NEED A PLACE TO LIE LOW.

PIERCE ISN'T WORKING ALONE. ZOLA'S ALGORITHM WAS ON THE *LEMURIAN STAR.*

SO WAS *JASPER SITWELL.*

SO, THE REAL QUESTION IS HOW DO THE TWO MOST WANTED PEOPLE IN WASHINGTON KIDNAP A S.H.I.E.L.D. OFFICER IN BROAD DAYLIGHT?

THE ANSWER IS, YOU *DON'T.*

CALL IT A RESUME.

I CAN'T ASK YOU TO DO THIS, SAM. YOU GOT OUT FOR A GOOD REASON.

DUDE, CAPTAIN AMERICA NEEDS MY HELP. THERE'S NO BETTER REASON TO GET BACK IN.

WHERE CAN WE GET OUR HANDS ON ONE OF THESE THINGS?

EXO-7 FALCON

LATER...

WAIT. WHAT ABOUT THAT GIRL FROM ACCOUNTING, LAURA--

LILLIAN. LIP PIERCING, RIGHT?

YEAH, SHE'S CUTE.

YEAH. I'M NOT READY FOR THAT.

BWAAAAA!

HUFF! HUFF!

HELLO, SITWELL...

...TELL ME ABOUT ZOLA'S ALGORITHM.

IT'S A PROGRAM FOR CHOOSING INSIGHT'S TARGETS. THE 21ST CENTURY IS A DIGITAL BOOK. ZOLA TAUGHT HYDRA HOW TO ***READ*** IT.

IT EVALUATES PEOPLE'S ***PASTS*** TO PREDICT THEIR ***FUTURES.*** THEN THE INSIGHT HELICARRIERS CREATE A LIST OF POTENTIAL THREATS TO HYDRA, AND SCRATCH PEOPLE OFF THE LIST...A FEW ***MILLION*** AT A TIME.

LATER...ON THE HIGHWAY...

INSIGHT LAUNCHES IN 16 HOURS. WE'RE CUTTING IT CLOSE HERE, STEVE.

I KNOW. WE'LL USE SITWELL TO BYPASS THE DNA SCANS AND ACCESS THE HELICARRIERS DIRECTLY.

WHAT?! ARE YOU ***CRAZY?*** THAT IS A TERRIBLE, ***TERRIBLE*** IDEA.

THUMP

HYDRA DOESN'T LIKE *LEAKS...*

GYUK--!

GIYAAAAAA!

CRUNCH

GO!

THWAM

WHAM

CUT

CRACK

...BUCKY?

WHO THE HELL IS *BUCKY?*

KABOOM

DON'T MOVE, CAP!

IT WAS HIM. HE LOOKED RIGHT AT ME LIKE HE DIDN'T EVEN *KNOW* ME.

HOW IS THAT EVEN POSSIBLE? IT WAS, LIKE, *70 YEARS* AGO.

ZOLA EXPERIMENTED ON BUCKY WHEN HIS UNIT WAS CAPTURED IN '43.

KSSZZZZ

THAT THING WAS SQUEEZING MY BRAIN...

...WHO'S THE NEW GUY?

LATER...

TETRODOTOXIN B. SLOWS THE PULSE TO ONE BEAT A MINUTE. BANNER DEVELOPED IT FOR *STRESS*.

ANY ATTEMPT ON THE DIRECTOR'S LIFE HAD TO LOOK SUCCESSFUL.

BUT WHY ALL THE SECRECY?

CAN'T KILL YOU IF YOU'RE ALREADY DEAD.

"WE HAVE TO STOP THE LAUNCH. ONCE THE HELICARRIERS REACH 3,000 FEET THEY'LL TRIANGULATE WITH INSIGHT SATELLITES AND BECOME *FULLY* WEAPONIZED."

presure 78%

data confirmati

WE NEED TO BREACH ALL THREE CARRIERS AND REPLACE THEIR TARGETING BLADES WITH OUR OWN FOR THIS TO WORK.

WE'RE NOT JUST TAKING DOWN THE CARRIERS, NICK. WE'RE TAKING DOWN *S.H.I.E.L.D.* S.H.I.E.L.D., HYDRA... IT *ALL* GOES.

WELL... IT LOOKS LIKE YOU'RE GIVING THE ORDERS NOW, CAPTAIN.

DEEP WITHIN THE IDEAL FEDERAL SAVINGS BANK...

BUCKY, NO!

SERGEANT BARNES. THE PROCEDURE HAS ALREADY STARTED.

YOU ARE TO BE THE NEW FIST OF HYDRA...

...PUT HIM ON *ICE*...

SIR, HE'S UNSTABLE. *ERRATIC.*

MISSION REPORT. MISSION REPORT *NOW.*

THE MAN ON THE BRIDGE...I *KNEW* HIM. WHO WAS HE?

YOU MET HIM EARLIER THIS WEEK ON ANOTHER ASSIGNMENT.

BUT I *KNEW* HIM.

WIPE HIM AND START OVER.

DECADES AGO...

MY FOLKS WANTED TO GIVE YOU A RIDE TO THE CEMETERY, STEVE.

I KNOW, I'M SORRY. I JUST KIND OF WANTED TO BE ALONE.

I WAS GONNA ASK...WE CAN PUT THE COUCH CUSHIONS ON THE FLOOR, LIKE WHEN WE WERE KIDS.

THANK YOU, BUCK, BUT I CAN GET BY ON MY OWN.

THE THING IS... YOU DON'T ***HAVE*** TO. I'M WITH YOU TO THE END OF THE LINE, PAL.

HE'S GONNA BE THERE, YOU KNOW.

I KNOW.

LOOK, WHOEVER HE USED TO BE AND THE GUY HE IS NOW, I DON'T THINK HE'S THE KIND YOU SAVE. HE'S THE KIND YOU ***STOP.***

HE DOESN'T KNOW YOU.

HE WILL.

GEAR UP. IT'S TIME.

YOU GONNA WEAR THAT?

NO. IF YOU'RE GONNA FIGHT A WAR, YOU GOT TO WEAR A ***UNIFORM.***

THE TRISKELION.

FINALLY, WE'RE HERE. AND THE WORLD SHOULD BE GRATEFUL.

ATTENTION ALL S.H.I.E.L.D. AGENTS. THIS IS ***STEVE ROGERS.*** YOU'VE HEARD A LOT ABOUT ME OVER THE LAST FEW DAYS. BUT I THINK IT'S TIME YOU KNOW THE TRUTH.

S.H.I.E.L.D. IS NOT WHAT WE THOUGHT IT WAS. IT'S BEEN TAKEN OVER BY ***HYDRA.***

ALEXANDER PIERCE IS THEIR LEADER.

THE S.T.R.I.K.E. AND INSIGHT CREWS ARE HYDRA AS WELL. I DON'T KNOW HOW MANY MORE... BUT I KNOW THEY'RE IN THE ***BUILDING.***

THEY ALMOST HAVE WHAT THEY WANT: ***ABSOLUTE CONTROL.*** THEY SHOT NICK FURY. AND IT WON'T END THERE.

IF YOU LAUNCH THOSE HELICARRIERS TODAY HYDRA WILL BE ABLE TO KILL ANYONE THAT STANDS IN THEIR WAY. UNLESS WE STOP THEM.

I KNOW I'M ASKING A LOT. BUT THE PRICE OF FREEDOM IS HIGH. AND IT'S A PRICE I'M WILLING TO PAY. AND IF I'M THE ONLY ONE THEN SO BE IT. BUT I'M WILLING TO BET I'M ***NOT.***

I GUESS I'VE GOT THE FLOOR.

SEND THOSE SHIPS UP NOW.

IS THERE A PROBLEM?

I'M--*UM*, I'M NOT GONNA LAUNCH THOSE SHIPS. CAPTAIN'S ORDERS.

MOVE AWAY FROM YOUR STATION.

LIKE HE SAID, RUMLOW... CAPTAIN'S ORDERS.

CLK

YOU PICKED THE WRONG SIDE, AGENT.

DEPENDS ON WHERE YOU'RE ***STANDING.***

BLAM BLAM

INSIGHT LAUNCH OVERRIDE.

HEY, CAP, HOW DO WE KNOW THE GOOD GUYS FROM THE BAD GUYS?

IF THEY'RE ***SHOOTING*** AT YOU, THEY'RE ***BAD.***

WORLD SECURITY COUNCIL.

CRACK

THWACK

I'M SORRY, SECRETARY PIERCE...

...DID I STEP ON YOUR MOMENT?

ALPHA LEVEL CONFIRMED. ENCRYPTION CODE ACCEPTED.

WHAT IS SHE DOING?

DISABLING SECURITY PROTOCOLS AND DUMPING ALL THE SECRETS ONTO THE INTERNET.

SAFEGUARDS REMOVED.

TRANSFER COMPLETE.

DONE. AND IT'S *TRENDING.*

BOOM

KABOOM

BRAVO LOCK.

INSIGHT HELICARRIER CHARLIE.

PEOPLE ARE GONNA DIE, BUCK. I CAN'T LET THAT HAPPEN.

PLEASE DON'T MAKE ME DO THIS.

SHK

ALPHA LOCK.

30 SECONDS, CAP.

STAND BY--

BLAM

AUGH!

THAT'S ENOUGH.

DEET

AAAAH!

HSSSSS

HSSSSS

AAAH!

UNLESS YOU WANT A TWO-INCH HOLE IN YOUR STERNUM, I'D PUT THAT GUN DOWN.

ZZZZTT

BLAM

ROMANOFF. NATASHA.

NATASHA! COME ON!

THOSE REALLY DO STING.

NNN-- CHARLIE. CHARLIE LOCK.

MEANWHILE...

OKAY, CAP, GET OUT OF THERE.

MARIA, FIRE NOW.

BUT, STEVE--

DO IT! DO IT NOW!

KABOOM

BUCKY...

YOUR NAME IS JAMES BUCHANAN BARNES.

SHUT UP!

I'M NOT GONNA FIGHT YOU. YOU'RE MY FRIEND.

YOU'RE MY MISSION.

YOU'RE MY MISSION!

WHAM

THEN *FINISH* IT. 'CAUSE I'M WITH YOU...TO THE END OF THE LINE.

SPLASH

=HYAK! HYAK!=

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE.

DO YOU SOLEMNLY SWEAR TO TELL THE TRUTH, THE WHOLE TRUTH, AND NOTHING BUT THE TRUTH?

I DO.

WHY HAVEN'T WE YET HEARD FROM CAPTAIN ROGERS?

I THINK THE WRECK IN THE MIDDLE OF THE POTOMAC MADE HIS POINT FAIRLY ELOQUENTLY.

AGENT ROMANOFF, YOU SHOULD KNOW THAT THERE ARE SOME ON THIS COMMITTEE WHO FEEL, GIVEN YOUR SERVICE RECORD BOTH FOR THIS COUNTRY AND ***AGAINST*** IT, THAT YOU BELONG IN A PENITENTIARY. NOT MOUTHING OFF ON CAPITOL HILL.

YOU'RE NOT GOING TO PUT ME IN A PRISON. YOU ***NEED*** US...

"...YES, THE WORLD IS A VULNERABLE PLACE. AND YES, WE HELPED ***MAKE*** IT THAT WAY...

"...BUT WE'RE ALSO THE ONES BEST QUALIFIED TO ***DEFEND*** IT...

CIA

STARK

"SO, IF YOU WANT TO ARREST ME, ARREST ME."

YOU'LL KNOW WHERE TO FIND ME.

COL NICHOLAS J FURY

THE PATH OF THE RIGHTEOUS MAN

SO, YOU'VE EXPERIENCED THIS SORT OF THING BEFORE.

YOU GET USED TO IT.

WE'VE BEEN DATA MINING HYDRA'S FILES. LOOKS LIKE A LOT OF RATS DIDN'T GO DOWN WITH THE SHIP.

HOW ABOUT IT, WILSON? COULD USE A MAN WITH YOUR ABILITIES.

I'M MORE OF A SOLDIER THAN A SPY.

ALL RIGHT THEN.

ANYBODY ASKS FOR ME, TELL THEM THEY CAN FIND ME... RIGHT ***HERE.***

YOU SHOULD BE HONORED. THAT'S ABOUT AS CLOSE AS HE GETS TO SAYING THANK YOU.

THAT THING YOU ASKED FOR--I CALLED IN A FEW FAVORS FROM KIEV.

YOU BE CAREFUL, STEVE...

...YOU MIGHT NOT WANT TO PULL ON THAT THREAD.

YOU'RE GOING AFTER HIM.

YOU DON'T HAVE TO COME WITH ME.

I KNOW... WHEN DO WE START?

TO BE CONTINUED IN MARVEL'S CAPTAIN AMERICA: CIVIL WAR INFINITE MCU PRELUDE.


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